

CSC 648 / CSC 848 — Section 03

Milestone 1 — Version 2

Home4U

AI-Assisted, Budget-Aware Interior Style Matching Platform

Team Number: 4

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REVISION HISTORY

Version	Date	Author(s)	Description
0.1	Feb 1, 2026	Team	Initial draft
1.0	Feb 8, 2026	Team	Version 1 submission
2.0	Feb 19, 2026	Team	Revised based on instructor feedback; completed use cases, diagrams, functional requirements, competitive analysis

1. Executive Summary

Home4U is a web-based interior style guidance platform designed to bridge the gap between visual inspiration and actionable transformation. Existing platforms such as Pinterest, Houzz, and Wayfair provide visual inspiration or shopping access, but they do not translate aesthetic styles into structured, budget-aware recommendations tailored to a user's actual space.

Home4U enables renters and first-time apartment dwellers to upload a room image, select desired interior styles (e.g., Modern, Japandi, Industrial), and receive AI-assisted tag suggestions describing current room characteristics. Using a weighted resemblance scoring algorithm, the system computes similarity between the user's room and the selected style(s). Based on this score, Home4U generates prioritized recommendations that maximize aesthetic impact within a defined budget.

Unlike competitors, Home4U integrates explainable scoring, human-validated AI tagging, multi-style comparison, and budget-aware prioritization within a single structured workflow.

The system architecture consists of a React frontend, FastAPI backend (Python 3.12), PostgreSQL relational database, and OpenAI Vision API for tag suggestion, deployed on AWS EC2 behind an Nginx reverse proxy secured with SSL/TLS.

2. Main Use Cases

2.1 Actors

- **User (Renter)**
 - **Administrator**
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2.2 Structured Use Cases

UC-01: Create Account

Primary Actor: User

Preconditions: User is not authenticated

Postconditions: User account is created and stored

Main Flow:

1. User selects "Sign Up".
2. User enters email and password.
3. System validates input format.
4. System hashes password.
5. System stores user record.
6. System confirms account creation.

Alternative Flow:

- 3a: Email already exists → system displays error.
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UC-02: Create Room Project

Primary Actor: User

Preconditions: User authenticated

Postconditions: RoomProject created

Main Flow:

1. User selects "Create Room".
 2. User enters room type.
 3. System creates RoomProject record.
 4. System confirms creation.
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UC-03: Upload Room Image

Primary Actor: User

Preconditions: RoomProject exists

Postconditions: Image stored and linked

Main Flow:

1. User uploads image.
 2. System validates file type.
 3. System stores image reference.
 4. System associates image with RoomProject.
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UC-04: Select Target Style

Primary Actor: User

Preconditions: RoomProject exists

Postconditions: Style(s) selected

Main Flow:

1. User selects one or more styles.
 2. System associates styles with RoomProject.
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UC-05: Confirm Tags

Primary Actor: User

Preconditions: Image uploaded

Postconditions: Confirmed tags stored

Main Flow:

1. System generates suggested tags.
 2. User reviews suggestions.
 3. User edits or confirms tags.
 4. System stores confirmed RoomTags.
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UC-06: Compute Resemblance Score

Primary Actor: System

Preconditions: Confirmed tags exist

Postconditions: Score stored

Main Flow:

1. System retrieves StyleTag weights.
 2. System compares RoomTags with StyleTags.
 3. System calculates normalized score.
 4. System stores ResemblanceScore.
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UC-07: Compare Multiple Styles

Primary Actor: User

Preconditions: Multiple styles selected

Postconditions: Comparison displayed

Main Flow:

1. System computes score for each style.
 2. System displays comparison view.
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UC-08: Input Budget Constraint

Primary Actor: User

Preconditions: Score calculated

Postconditions: Budget stored

Main Flow:

1. User inputs budget.
 2. System validates amount.
 3. System stores budget constraint.
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UC-09: Generate Recommendations

Primary Actor: System

Preconditions: Budget and score available

Postconditions: Recommendations displayed

Main Flow:

1. System identifies missing style tags.
 2. System ranks improvements by impact-to-cost ratio.
 3. System displays prioritized recommendations.
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UC-10: Manage Style Definitions (Admin)

Primary Actor: Administrator

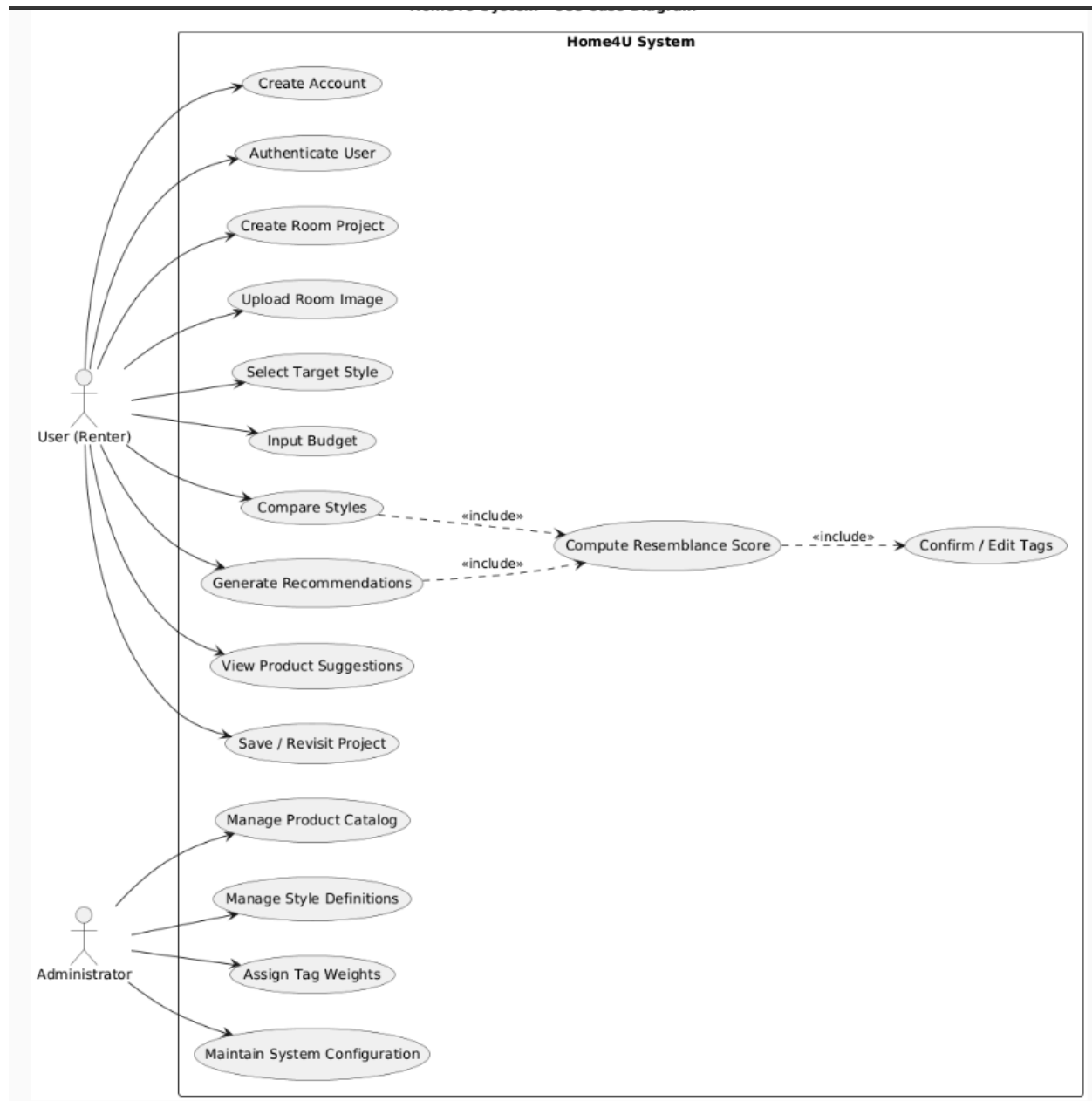
Preconditions: Admin authenticated

Postconditions: Style data updated

Main Flow:

1. Admin edits style definition.
2. Admin modifies tag weights.
3. System updates database.

2.3 Use Case Diagram



Actors:

- User
- Administrator

System boundary:

- Home4U System

Use cases inside system:

- Create Account
 - Upload Image
 - Select Style
 - Confirm Tags
 - Compute Score
 - Generate Recommendations
 - Manage Styles
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3. Main Data Items and Entities

Each entity includes attributes and relationships.

3.1 User

- user_id (PK)
- email
- password_hash
- created_at

Relationship:

- One-to-many with RoomProject

3.2 RoomProject

- room_id (PK)
- user_id (FK)
- room_type
- budget

Relationship:

- One-to-many with RoomTag

3.3 Style

- style_id (PK)
- name
- description

3.4 Tag

- tag_id (PK)
- name

3.5 StyleTag

- style_id (FK)
- tag_id (FK)
- weight

3.6 RoomTag

- room_id (FK)
- tag_id (FK)

3.7 ResemblanceScore

- score_id (PK)
- room_id (FK)
- style_id (FK)
- score_value

3.8 Recommendation

- recommendation_id (PK)
- room_id (FK)
- description
- priority_score

3.9 ProductItem

- product_id (PK)
- style_id (FK)
- name
- estimated_cost
- url

4. Functional Requirements

4.1 User Requirements

USR-01: System shall allow user registration.
USR-02: System shall authenticate users securely.
USR-03: System shall allow creation of RoomProject.
USR-04: System shall allow image upload.
USR-05: System shall allow style selection.
USR-06: System shall allow tag confirmation.

4.2 RoomProject Requirements

RP-01: System shall create RoomProject records.
RP-02: System shall associate RoomProject with User.
RP-03: System shall store budget constraint.

4.3 Style Requirements

ST-01: System shall store predefined styles.
ST-02: Admin shall modify style definitions.

4.4 Scoring Requirements

SC-01: System shall compute weighted resemblance score.
SC-02: System shall normalize scores to 0–100.
SC-03: System shall support multi-style comparison.

4.5 Recommendation Requirements

REC-01: System shall generate prioritized recommendations.
REC-02: System shall rank recommendations by impact-to-cost ratio.

5. Non-Functional Requirements

5.1 Performance

NFR-P-01: Scoring shall complete within 5 seconds.

5.2 Reliability

NFR-R-01: System shall maintain 99% uptime.

5.3 Security

NFR-S-01: Passwords shall be hashed and salted.
NFR-S-02: JWT authentication shall be implemented.
NFR-S-03: All communication shall occur over HTTPS using SSL/TLS.

5.4 Usability

NFR-U-01: Interface shall be responsive.

5.5 Scalability

NFR-SC-01: System shall support concurrent users.

5.6 Maintainability

NFR-M-01: Code shall follow PEP8 guidelines.
NFR-M-02: Functions shall include docstrings.

5.7 Coding Standards

- CS-01: Backend shall use Python 3.12.
- CS-02: REST endpoints shall follow consistent naming conventions.
- CS-03: React 18 functional components required.
- CS-04: Git branching strategy must be followed.
- CS-05: No hardcoded secrets permitted.
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6. Competitive Analysis

6.1 Table 1 – Feature Comparison

Product	Personalization	Style Scoring	Budget Filter	Shopping Integration
Pinterest	No	No	No	Indirect
Houzz	Limited	No	No	Yes
IKEA Planner	Limited	No	Limited	Yes
Havenly	Yes	No	No	Yes
Wayfair Ideas	Limited	No	No	Yes

6.2 Table 2 – Weakness & Opportunity Matrix

Competitor	Weakness	Opportunity for Home4U
Pinterest	No structured recommendations	Provide explainable scoring
Houzz	No scoring system	Add measurable similarity index
IKEA Planner	Store-specific	Multi-brand neutrality
Havenly	Paid service	Self-guided free alternative
Wayfair	No personalization engine	AI-assisted personalization

6.3 Analytical Summary

Existing platforms focus either on inspiration or commerce but lack explainable personalization. None provide a quantitative resemblance scoring system combined with budget-aware prioritization. Home4U differentiates itself by integrating structured scoring, AI-assisted tagging, and cost-impact ranking into a single user workflow.

6.4 Target Audience Validation

A preliminary validation exercise was conducted with six renters aged 21–30. Five reported difficulty translating visual inspiration into actionable steps within a fixed budget. Four expressed interest in a scoring system that quantifies style similarity. These findings support the need for structured, budget-aware personalization.

7. Project Readiness Checklist

- ☑ Meeting schedule established
 - ☑ Roles assigned
 - ☑ Tools selected
 - ☑ Repository organized
 - ☑ Python version standardized
 - ☑ SSL planned
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8. High-Level Architecture and Technologies

Frontend (React 18)
→ FastAPI (Python 3.12)
→ PostgreSQL 16
→ OpenAI Vision API
→ Nginx Reverse Proxy
→ AWS EC2 (Ubuntu 22.04 LTS)
→ SSL via Let's Encrypt

9. Team Contributions

The team divided responsibilities based on technical strengths while ensuring collaborative review of all major deliverables. Each member was responsible for primary ownership of specific sections and technical components.